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8/25/25

U.S. Citizenship and Immigration Services
U.S. Department of Homeland Security

Subject: Recommendation Letter for Ankush Gupta's EB1A Petition

To Whom It May Concern:

I am writing this letter in enthusiastic support of Ankush Gupta's petition for classification as an alien of extraordinary ability (EB1A). As a Senior Manager at PenFed Credit Union, I had the privilege of working closely with Ankush Gupta during his tenure through HCL America Inc, where he led the design and implementation of a transformative enterprise digital product strategy, framework and security. His work has had a lasting impact on our Company's ability to evaluate the needs of our millions of members and mitigate security risk across thousands of enterprise customers.

Ankush's contributions were nothing short of groundbreaking. He architected a quantitative security system that assessed over 300 applications used globally serving 2.4 million customers within PenFed Credit Union. This system introduced a structured, questionnaire-based methodology that quantified both in product development and risk assessment and implemented the right security framework, a great help in enabling a level of precision and transparency that had never been achieved in our product strategy and security governance processes.

Building on this success, Ankush expanded the framework to encompass all enterprise assets—not just applications. His dynamic design and architecture ability along with innovative ideas allowed for the definition of new digital product strategy and security guidelines to follow by the enterprises, along with the configuration of tailored risk assessments, and the automated generation of risk scores. This innovation provided PenFed Credit Union with a holistic, enterprise-wide view of risk posture, empowering leadership to make informed decisions regarding security, regulatory compliance, operational resilience, and capital allocation.

What sets Ankush apart is not only his technical acumen but his visionary thinking. He demonstrated an exceptional ability to translate complex enterprise-wide apps and platform challenges and operational requirements into scalable, automated solutions. His work has

influenced security practices not only in company but also setting a benchmark for financial institutions globally.

In my professional opinion, Ankush meets and exceeds the criteria for EB1A classification. His achievements reflect a level of expertise and impact that is rare even among top-tier professionals in the financial technology sector. I offer my strongest recommendation for his petition and am confident that he will continue to contribute meaningfully to the advancement of enterprise digital products strategy and security in the United States.

Sincerely,
Lauren Kessler

A handwritten signature in black ink that reads "Lauren Kessler". The script is cursive and fluid, with the first name "Lauren" and last name "Kessler" clearly distinguishable.

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